

Back with a Bang

Rewriting its script for success, the Indian box office is finally back in action

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► **ONE OF THE** miracle stories in the aftermath of the devastating Covid-19 pandemic has been the Indian box office. It has demonstrated not only remarkable resilience in the face of other technological advancements, such as the rise of streaming services, but post-pandemic, it has come back with a vengeance. According to a report by India's largest multiplex chain, PVR INOX, the

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Indian box office has experienced a notable growth of 12%, reaching \$1.5 billion in 2023 from \$1.3 billion in 2019. This stands in stark contrast to substantial declines of 17% and 20%, respectively, in markets like China and the US during the same period. No wonder then that Ajay Bijli, the Managing Director of PVR INOX, is in a jubilant mood.

"It is truly heartening to see In-